

Play Mode Changes Saver

Complete User Guide & Documentation

Capture, Review, and Apply Your Play Mode Modifications

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1. What is Play Mode Changes Saver?

Play Mode Changes Saver is a powerful Unity Editor tool that automatically captures modifications you make during Play Mode testing. Instead of losing your valuable iterations when you exit Play Mode, this tool lets you review, compare, and selectively apply the changes you want to keep permanently to your scene.

Think of it as a safety net for your Play Mode experiments—when you discover the perfect position for a GameObject or find the ideal component value while testing, you can save those changes with just a few clicks instead of manually recreating them.

Why You Need This Tool

- You spend time adjusting values during Play Mode testing, only to lose everything when you exit
- You have to manually recreate important tweaks you discovered during testing
- You're not sure which changes you made or how to reproduce them
- You want an easy way to selectively keep some changes but discard others

What This Tool Does

- Automatically captures snapshots of all your GameObjects when entering Play Mode
- Detects every change you make: positions, rotations, component values, GameObject names, and more
- Shows you exactly what changed in an easy-to-read, side-by-side comparison
- Lets you pick and choose which changes to save during Play Mode
- Applies your saved changes permanently to your scene after exiting Play Mode

2. Installation Guide

Installation Steps

Step 1: Open the Package Manager

In Unity Editor, click: Window → Package Manager

Step 2: Navigate to My Assets

In the Package Manager window, find the dropdown menu at the top left and select "My Assets" from the list.

Step 3: Find Play Mode Changes Saver

Search for "Play Mode Changes Saver" in the search box. Click on the package name to select it.

Step 4: Import the Tool

Click the "Import" button and wait for the import process to complete.

Step 5: You're Done!

The tool is installed and ready to use. No additional configuration is needed—it works automatically.

Verify Installation

To confirm the tool is installed correctly, check for:

- A new menu option: Tools → Play Mode Overrides Browser
- No error messages in the Console window

If you see these, you're ready to go!

3. How to Use Play Mode Changes Saver

Quick Start & Example Usage

Your First Time Using Play Mode Changes Saver

Let's see the tool in action with these simple steps:

1. Open any scene in your project
2. Make sure you have at least one GameObject in your scene (for example, a Cube)
3. Press Play to enter Play Mode
4. While in Play Mode, modify something on that GameObject:
 - Move it by changing its Position values in the Inspector
 - Change its Scale or Rotation
 - Modify any component property (e.g., change a Collider)
5. IMPORTANT: Save your changes during Play Mode
 - A "Play Mode Overrides" button will appear in the Inspector header
 - Click this button to see all detected changes
 - Click "Apply All" to save the changes
 - NOTE: Changes are only saved if you explicitly click Apply — they are NOT saved automatically!
6. Exit Play Mode
7. Apply your saved changes:

After exiting Play Mode, a dialog box titled "Apply Overrides" will appear, asking if you want to apply play mode overrides for the scene.

Select one of the options:

- Click Apply to save your modifications
- Click Discard to lose your changes

Additional Steps for Multiple Scenes (Optional):

If you have modified multiple scenes, follow these subsequent steps:

- Confirm Scene Switch: In the "Scene Switch" dialog, confirm if you want to switch to the next modified scene (e.g., Scene02.unity)
 - Click Yes to proceed to the next override prompt
 - Click Discard remaining to cancel all pending changes for all the remaining scenes at once
- Apply Further Overrides: For each additional scene, the "Apply Overrides" dialog will reappear. Choose Apply to save or Discard to reject the changes for that specific scene
- Return to Start Scene: Finally, a "Return to start scene?" dialog will appear, asking if you want to go back to your original scene (e.g., Scene01.unity)
 - Click Yes to return to the initial starting scene
 - Click No to remain in the current scene

That's it! Your changes are now permanently saved to your scene.

4. Understanding the Workflow

How Play Mode Changes Saver Works (Step-by-Step):

BEFORE ENTERING PLAY MODE:

- The tool automatically clears any previously saved changes from earlier sessions
- This ensures you start with a clean slate every time you test

ENTERING PLAY MODE:

- The tool automatically captures a snapshot of your scene (all GameObjects, components, and values)
- This snapshot serves as the baseline for detecting changes
- This happens silently in the background—no action needed from you

DURING PLAY MODE:

- As you make changes, the tool compares current values against the baseline snapshot
- When changes are detected on a GameObject, a "Play Mode Overrides" button appears in its Inspector
- Click this button to review changes and decide what to save
- **IMPORTANT:** You **MUST** click "Apply All" (or similar buttons) to save changes
- Only explicitly saved changes will be available after exiting Play Mode
- Un-applied changes will be lost when you exit Play Mode (standard Unity behavior)

EXITING PLAY MODE:

- Unity reverts all Play Mode changes as usual (this is standard Unity behavior)
- However, any changes you explicitly saved via the Inspector are stored persistently
- IF you saved changes during Play Mode, a dialog appears asking whether to apply or discard them
- IF you didn't save any changes, no dialog appears—everything returns to normal

APPLYING CHANGES (AFTER PLAY MODE):

- Review and apply/discard your saved changes scene by scene
- Applied changes are written to your scene files using Unity's Undo system
- You can undo applied changes with Ctrl+Z / Cmd+Z if needed

Key Takeaway:

Changes are NOT automatically saved. You must explicitly click "Apply All" (or similar buttons) in the Inspector popup during Play Mode. Only then will changes be available to apply after exiting Play Mode.

5. Key Features Explained

Play Mode Changes Saver provides three main ways to interact with your changes:

FEATURE 1: Inspector Panel (Per-Object Review)

AVAILABLE: Only during Play Mode

This is the quickest way to save changes for individual GameObjects during Play Mode.

Where to find it:

When a GameObject has detected changes, look at its Inspector panel. At the top, you'll see a button labeled "Play Mode Overrides." Click this button to see all changes for that specific object.

What it shows:

- A list of all components that changed on this GameObject
- Quick action buttons:
 - Apply All: Saves all changes for this GameObject
 - Revert to Original: Restores values from before Play Mode
 - Revert to Saved: Restores previously saved values

How to use it:

1. Select a GameObject with changes
2. Click "Play Mode Overrides" button in the Inspector header
3. Click "Apply All" to save all changes (or use other buttons for selective control)
4. Repeat for other GameObjects as needed

Best for: Quick decisions on individual GameObjects while testing

 **IMPORTANT:** Only changes you explicitly apply will be saved. Un-applied changes are lost when exiting Play Mode.

FEATURE 2: Comparison Popup (Detailed Review)

AVAILABLE: Only during Play Mode

For a detailed, side-by-side comparison of your changes before saving them.

Where to find it:

Click on any component name in the Play Mode Overrides panel. A popup window appears showing:

Layout:

- Left side (Original): Values from before Play Mode (grayed out, read-only)
- Right side (Current): Current values during Play Mode (editable)
- Buttons at bottom: Apply, Revert to Original, Revert to Saved

What you can do:

- See exactly which properties changed and by how much
- Edit current values directly in the popup if needed
- Apply changes for just this component (or revert them)

Best for: Understanding exactly what changed and making fine-tuned decisions before saving.

FEATURE 3: Overrides Browser (Complete Overview)

AVAILABLE: Both Play Mode and Edit Mode

A bird's-eye view of all applied changes in your current scene.

Where to find it: Click “Tools > Play Mode Overrides Browser” in the top menu bar. A new window opens showing:

- Every GameObject in the scene, that has applied changes, presented in a dropdown format
- Each component of the GameObject that has been modified.

You can also click on any component here to open the same detailed comparison window described in Feature 2

Best for: Managing large projects with many changes across multiple GameObjects.

6. Supported Changes & Components

This tool tracks changes to properties and fields in Unity built-in components and your custom scripts.

What Gets Tracked:

- **Transform:**
 - position, rotation, scale (local space)
- **RectTransform:**
 - anchors, pivots, offsets, sizeDelta, anchoredPosition, anchoredPosition3D
 - anchorMin, anchorMax, offsetMin, offsetMax
- **Renderer:**
 - material assignments
- **GameObject:**
 - name changes
- **All Unity Built-In Components:**
 - public fields
 - [SerializeField] private fields
- **Custom MonoBehaviours & ScriptableObjects:**
 - public fields
 - [SerializeField] private fields
- **Supported Field Types:**
 - Primitives: int, float, bool, string, char
 - Vectors: Vector2, Vector3, Vector4, Vector2Int, Vector3Int
 - Colors: Color, Color32
 - Unity types: LayerMask, Gradient, Rect, Bounds, Quaternion
 - Object References: GameObject, Transform, Rigidbody, Material, Mesh, Sprite, Texture, AnimationClip, and other Unity Object types
 - Collections: Arrays and Lists of supported types
 - Enums: built-in and custom enums

Not Tracked:

- Private fields without [SerializeField] attribute
- Runtime-created objects (GameObjects spawned during Play Mode that don't exist in Edit Mode)
- Component additions/removals (only property changes on existing components)
- Prefab modifications

7. Technical Details

How It Works (Behind the Scenes):

- ENTERING PLAY MODE:
 1. The tool automatically creates a snapshot of your scene (all GameObjects, components, and property values)
 2. This snapshot is stored in memory for change detection during Play Mode
 3. Any previously stored changes from earlier sessions are cleared to start fresh
 4. This happens silently without user notification
- DURING PLAY MODE:
 1. As you make changes, the tool automatically detects them when the Inspector refreshes
 2. A "Play Mode Overrides" button appears in the Inspector for GameObjects with detected changes
 3. ⚠ Changes are NOT automatically saved—you must explicitly click "Apply All" (or similar buttons) in the Inspector popup to record them
 4. Only explicitly applied changes will be available after exiting Play Mode
 5. Change detection has minimal performance impact during normal Play Mode testing
- EXITING PLAY MODE:
 1. Unity reverts all Play Mode changes as usual (standard Unity behavior)
 2. If you saved changes during Play Mode (via the Inspector popup), they remain in persistent storage
 3. Changes are stored in persistent ScriptableObject assets located in: Assets/PlayModeChangesSaver/Scriptable_Objects/
 4. A dialog appears only if you have saved changes, guiding you through applying or discarding them scene-by-scene
 5. If you didn't save any changes during Play Mode, no dialog appears
- APPLYING CHANGES IN EDIT MODE:
 1. After exiting Play Mode, dialogs prompt you to apply or discard saved changes for each affected scene
 2. When you choose to apply, the tool modifies your scene's serialized data using Unity's Undo system
 3. All changes are saved to the scene file
 4. You can undo with Ctrl+Z (Cmd+Z on Mac) if needed
 5. Full Undo/Redo integration with Unity's system

Performance & Resource Usage:

- **MEMORY:**
 - Snapshots are typically a few KB per scene and stored in memory
 - Multiple scenes are handled efficiently with per-scene snapshots
 - In-memory snapshots are cleared when you enter Play Mode again
 - Persistent storage assets remain in the project until cleared or overwritten
- **CPU:**
 - Minimal impact during Play Mode testing (change detection runs during Inspector refreshes)
 - Snapshot creation is fast and runs automatically when entering Play Mode
 - Change detection compares current values with baseline snapshots efficiently
- **DISK SPACE:**
 - Persistent ScriptableObject storage assets remain in: Assets/PlayModeChangesSaver/Scriptable_Objects/
 - Storage assets are cleared automatically when entering Play Mode (to start fresh)
 - Applied changes become part of your scene files (minimal size increase)
 - Storage assets can be safely deleted manually if needed (they are auto-created as needed)

Undo/Redo Support:

- Each applied change (transform, component, or name) is registered with Unity's Undo system
- Use Ctrl+Z (Cmd+Z on Mac) to undo individual applied changes
- Use Ctrl+Y (Cmd+Y on Mac) to redo undone changes
- Scene save prompts work normally after applying changes
- Full compatibility with all Unity editing workflows

Multi-Scene Support:

- The tool handles additively loaded scenes and multi-scene workflows:
- Automatically tracks changes across all loaded scenes during Play Mode
- After exiting Play Mode, processes each affected scene individually with separate dialogs
- Allows you to review and decide (apply or discard) for each scene independently
- Automatically switches between scenes during the review process if needed
- Offers to return you to your starting scene after completing the review workflow
- Each scene's changes are identified using normalized scene paths and GlobalObjectId mapping
- No conflicts between scenes - each maintains its own change records

8. Troubleshooting & FAQ

- **Q:** I made changes during Play Mode but no dialog appeared after exiting. Why?
A: The dialog only appears if you explicitly save changes during Play Mode by clicking "Apply All" (or similar buttons) in the Inspector popup. If you didn't click Apply, the changes were not saved.
- **Q:** Can I undo applied changes?
A: Yes! All applied changes are fully integrated with Unity's Undo system. Press Ctrl+Z (Cmd+Z on Mac) to undo. You can also revert applied changes via the Play Mode Overrides Browser.
- **Q:** Will this slow down my Play Mode testing?
A: No. The tool has minimal performance impact. Change detection only runs when the Inspector refreshes, not every frame.
- **Q:** Can I use this with prefabs?
A: This tool tracks changes to prefab instances in scenes. To modify a prefab itself, open the prefab in Edit Mode and make changes there.
- **Q:** What happens if I rename or reparent a GameObject after saving changes?
A: The tool matches objects by GlobalObjectId. Renaming or reparenting after Play Mode can break the match, so keep hierarchies stable until you apply changes. Name changes made during Play Mode are tracked and can be applied.
- **Q:** Can I delete the Scriptable_Objects folder?
A: Yes, it's safe to delete the storage assets in Assets/PlayModeChangesSaver/Scriptable_Objects/ and the folder itself. They will be auto-created as needed.
- **Q:** Does this work with multiple scenes loaded additively?
A: Yes! The tool fully supports multi-scene workflows. You'll be prompted to apply or discard changes for each scene individually.
- **Q:** Can I review changes after exiting Play Mode?
A: Yes, use the "Tools → Play Mode Overrides Browser" window in Edit Mode to review all saved changes and also revert them if needed.

8. Contact & Support

Getting Help:

If you encounter issues not covered in this documentation:

GitHub Issues:

Visit: <https://github.com/062Leo/Unity-Runtime-Changes-Saver/issues>

Create a new issue with:

- Your Unity version
- A description of what went wrong
- Steps to reproduce the problem
- Screenshots if helpful

Email Support:

Use the contact form: <https://tally.so/r/KYx5ak>

Include:

- Your contact email
- Detailed description of the issue
- Unity version and project information

Giving Feedback & Rating:

This tool is provided for **free**. If you find it helpful, please:

1. Leave a positive rating on the Unity Asset Store
2. Write a review describing how the tool helped you
3. Your feedback helps improve the tool and makes it visible to other developers

Your support means a lot and motivates continued development!

Feature Request & Contributions:

Have an idea for a new feature? Want to contribute?

Visit the GitHub repository: <https://github.com/062Leo/Unity-Runtime-Changes-Saver>

You can:

- Suggest new features via GitHub Issues
- Report bugs you discover
- Contribute code improvements (pull requests welcome)
- Help improve documentation

Community involvement makes this tool better for everyone.